

INTERNSHIP INTERVIEW EXPERIENCE AT KLA TENCOR

About the Company:

KLA Corporation (NASDAQ: KLAC) is a global leader in process control and yield management solutions, specializing in advanced metrology and inspection technologies for the semiconductor, data storage, LED, and nanoelectronics industries. Headquartered in Milpitas, California, KLA operates globally with customer and service centers worldwide. Its technologies enable defect detection smaller than a wavelength of visible light, aiding in the production of high-performance chips.

Internship Role:

- **Position:** Software Engineering Intern
- **Duration:** 8-10 weeks
- **Location:** Chennai, India
- **Eligibility Criteria:**
 - Only female candidates
 - **CGPA:** 7.5 or above, with no standing arrears
- **Stipend:** Rs 90,000 for undergraduate students.

Interview Process:

The interview process for the Software Engineering Internship at KLA consisted of four rounds in total. It began with an online test and was followed by three interview rounds conducted at their premises.

Round 1: Online Test

This round was an online coding test with two questions, and the time limit was 1 hour. The questions were designed to test algorithmic thinking and problem-solving efficiency.

Question 1:

The problem involved distributing API requests across N servers (labelled from

1 to N), ensuring that the workload remained balanced. Each request added to the server's workload, and the goal was to determine which server would handle each request. If two servers had the same minimum workload, the one with the smaller label should handle the request.

Hint: My approach used a min-heap to efficiently track the least-loaded server, ensuring optimal load distribution for each request.

Question 2:

The second problem required minimizing the time to transfer a subsequence of size M from an array. The transfer time was the product of the first and last elements of the subsequence, and the task was to find the subsequence that minimized this product.

Hint: My approach was to sort the array, iterate over subsequences, calculate the product of the first and last elements of each subsequence, and track the minimum transfer time across all valid subsequences.

To excel in the online test, practicing regularly on coding platforms like LeetCode and HackerRank is essential. Consistency helps in understanding problems quickly and improves efficiency. Solving problems on these platforms also enhances your ability to develop optimal solutions under time constraints.

A week after the test, I was informed that 8 candidates, including myself, had been shortlisted for the next rounds.

Round 2: Technical Interview 1 (45 minutes)

This technical round took place in person and required solving three problem statements on paper. The problems were primarily focused on basic data structures and algorithms (DSA), covering topics such as arrays, strings, and queues.

- Start with a brute-force approach, and explain your thought process to the interviewer. The key is to keep the interviewer engaged by talking through your ideas and explaining the reasoning behind each line of code.
- Before diving into the solution, it's important to explain the understanding of the problem to the interviewer, ensuring it's

interpreted correctly. Actively communicating the approach, asking clarifying questions when needed, and explaining the reasoning at each step demonstrates critical thinking and collaborative skills. Avoid staying silent.

- It's crucial to solve all three questions correctly to increase your chances of advancing to the next round. Most successful candidates completed all the problems, so ensure you attempt every question and explain your approach clearly.

Time management is crucial - allocate enough time to attempt all three questions, and explain your changes as you go.

Out of 16 people who were interviewed, 10 of us were selected for the next round. I was fortunate to be one of them.

Round 3: Technical Interview 2 (45 minutes)

The second technical round involved more advanced DSA topics such as trees and graphs. This round had two problem statements, and I was required to solve them within the allotted time.

The interviewer was supportive and helped guide me through the problem, but it was important to explain each step clearly and concisely.

In addition to the technical aspect, communication was key in this round. They were also assessing my ability to explain solutions clearly and think logically under pressure. It was important to stay calm and manage time well to attempt both problems.

Round 4: HR Interview (20 minutes)

Out of the 8 candidates remaining, 6 of us advanced to the final HR round. This round was more relaxed and conversational, focusing on personality, communication skills, and cultural fit.

- This was the first time I was asked to introduce myself during the entire interview process. I delivered a well-prepared and confident introduction, aiming to leave a strong first impression. I explained my contributions to the projects on my resume, emphasizing my teamwork

skills, and ensured I had complete knowledge of it since the interview was based on it.

- I had researched KLA's history, recent achievements, and values. I explained how the company's vision aligned with my personal career goals, which helped me stand out.
- This part of the interview allowed me to showcase my interests outside of academics, presenting myself as a well-rounded individual.
- When asked if I had any questions, I made sure to ask thoughtful ones that demonstrated my enthusiasm for the role and the company. It's important not to say "no" to this question, as it provides an opportunity to leave a strong final impression.

Throughout the HR round, I maintained a positive attitude and projected enthusiasm for the opportunity at KLA.

Final Thoughts:

- Allocating time wisely during technical tests was crucial.
- Strong knowledge of Data Structures and Algorithms is key.
- Being on time is essential for professionalism.
- Ensure your resume reflects true experiences.

Hope this helps!

ALL THE BEST !!

Remember, "*Consistency turns ordinary efforts into extraordinary results.*"

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You've got this - Time to shine and slay the game!!